

OBSERVATION POST VACCINATION

- Observe patient for at least 15 minutes after vaccination. If patient known with severe allergies: observe for longer (30 minutes).
- Check for signs or symptoms that may indicate an adverse reaction:



Collapse →13.

Feeling faint/cardiovascular symptoms

- Light-headedness or dizziness
- Feeling warm or cold
- Sweating
- Palpitations
- Nausea
- Visual 'blurring' (darkening or white-out of vision)
- Reduced hearing ('whooshing' noise)
- Pallor reported by onlookers



- Ask patient to lean forward and his/her head between knees, or lie down flat, for several minutes until feeling better.
- Loosen tight clothing – undo buttons around neck, loosen tie/belt.
- Apply a cool cloth to his/her face or neck.
- Calmly reassure patient.

Skin/mucosal symptoms



- Itchiness
- Skin rash (hives)
- Swelling of eyes, lips, tongue, face, or hands/feet)
- Nasal congestion

Respiratory symptoms



- Wheeze or cough
- Throat tightness
- Stridor
- Shortness of breath
- Hoarseness
- Oxygen sats < 92%
- Trouble swallowing
- Drooling

Gastrointestinal symptoms



- Nausea
- Vomiting
- Diarrhoea
- Cramps

Do symptom/s improve quickly (minutes)?

Yes

Faintness likely
Observe until
symptoms resolve.

No

Decide when to treat for anaphylaxis
Are signs or symptoms generalised: are 2 or more body systems involved?

Yes

No. Does patient have generalised urticaria (raised red rash/hives) involving the whole body?

Yes

No. Are signs or symptoms serious or life-threatening, even if only single body system (hypotension, respiratory distress, or significant swelling of the tongue or lips)?

Yes

Treat as anaphylaxis →20.

No

- If isolated rash (raised, red rash in patient who is otherwise well without other symptoms):
 - Monitor for at least 30 minutes to pick up any other symptoms:
 - If no other associated symptoms and patient remains well, **pseudoallergic self-limiting rash** likely: reassure patient and advise to take oral antihistamines.
 - Advise to seek urgent health care if any of the following develop: swelling of face, lips or tongue; difficulty breathing, abdominal pain, nausea or vomiting.
- If other symptoms: discuss with doctor/specialist urgently.
- If in doubt, treat as anaphylaxis → 20.